FAMILY-04 | Therapist only - all age groups

Boundaries and solving a problem together

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Define a limited everyday problem, explore participants' needs, and choose an agreed trial with shared responsibilities. The agreement includes a way to stop, give feedback, and make changes; it is not a contract for obedience.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Safety, humiliation, and forced contact are not matters for negotiation. A child's agreement does not transfer adult responsibility to them. Do not use this sheet for punishment, covert monitoring, or evidence against a family member.

Reusing existing material

Build on needs and listening in FAMILY-02–03. Add one agreement with review conditions; solving every family conflict is unnecessary.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Two siblings want to use the table at the same time. With an adult, they choose a short trial of sharing the space and agree that they can ask for a change if there is not enough room.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What specific problem do we want to solve together?

2 | Question for discussion

What needs and boundaries must be considered?

3 | Question for discussion

What limited option is reasonable with available resources?

4 | Question for discussion

How will we share responsibility and support by agreement?

5 | Question for discussion

When will we review it, and how can we change or stop it?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If discussion expands to many issues, return to a small definition. If the problem is threat or coercion, replace negotiation with professional assessment and appropriate support.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Work on a small topic such as play space or preparing an item. An adult is responsible for conditions and safety; there are no rewards or punishments for the content of answers.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Include privacy, time, and freedom to raise concerns in the agreement. Do not treat initial consent as permanent consent or an excuse for monitoring without knowledge.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Explore constraints from work, caregiving, and finances. Check that agreement does not arise from fear of a reaction; work separately when needed.

OA | Older adults

Preserve the participant's right to choose a companion's presence and make decisions. An accessible solution should reflect their preferences, not only others' convenience.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose one trial that can be canceled or revised. Daily monitoring or rating family members is unnecessary; practicing in the session is a full alternative.

At the next session

Check what was practical and what remains open. An agreement needing change provides learning, not proof that someone is uncooperative.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nhs.uk/every-mind-matters/lifes-challenges/maintaining-healthy-relationships-and-mental-wellbeing/
www.unicef.org/eca/stories/how-communicate-effectively-your-young-child

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